

Thibault Fouache

Head of Engineering — Cloud-Native Platforms & Open-Source Infrastructure

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STARTUP LEADERSHIP · KUBERNETES-NATIVE SYSTEMS · OPEN SOURCE · SHIPPING CULTURE

Senior engineering leader with 15+ years turning small teams into high-impact execution engines and scaling to 50+ engineers as a manager of managers. Hands-on distributed-systems background across Kubernetes-based platforms, event-driven data architectures, and open-source stacks. Pragmatic, low-ego, direct — bias for shipping over process, comfortable in early-stage ambiguity.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Bazzile Technology SA

Aug 2020 – Present

Co-Founder, CTO / CPO — Partner

Co-founded an early-stage technology startup from zero to production. Owned engineering and product end-to-end — small team, open-source stack throughout, ship-weekly cadence, zero bureaucracy.

- Built the product and platform hands-on: Elixir/Phoenix services, PostgreSQL, cross-platform mobile (Flutter), infrastructure on Hetzner with container-based deployments thanks to Kamal.
- Sustained 99.95% uptime through reliability engineering, observability and incident practices installed from day one — not bolted on later.
- Ran product discovery directly with users, translated insights into a prioritised backlog, and shipped iteratively — balancing velocity with pragmatism under tight constraints.
- Recruited, coached and led a tight engineering unit optimised for ownership and customer impact over process.

Ripple

Sep 2023 – Oct 2025

Director of Software Engineering — Ripple Custody

Led an international engineering organisation of up to 50 engineers across Geneva and San Francisco, building a mission-critical, data-intensive platform on Kubernetes for top-tier institutional customers.

- Manager of managers: restructured the org into autonomous cross-functional squads with clear domain ownership, cutting coordination overhead and accelerating delivery.
- Scaled from 40 to 50 engineers — owned hiring end-to-end from job scoping and levelling to structured interview loops, calibrated bar, and close strategy. Continuously raised talent density.
- Installed lightweight execution systems: weekly planning, crisp milestones, directly responsible engineers per initiative — fewer escalations, faster decisions, higher throughput.
- Partnered closely with Product and customer-facing teams to translate priorities into realistic scopes, push back on execution risk, and shape roadmap with engineering perspective.
- Technical voice externally with key stakeholders and enterprise customers; ran 1:1s, addressed issues early, prevented management and culture debt.
- Achieved 96% team satisfaction through structured coaching, transparent goals and a culture of ownership — across time zones, remote-first.

FlowBank SA

Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

Global Head of Technology — Executive Director

- Led the entire IT department (~40 people) at a digital bank; defined strategy, annual technology roadmap and budget presented to the Executive Committee.
- Architected a real-time event-driven data platform (Apache Kafka) connecting trading, compliance, marketing and finance — distributed pipelines running on Kubernetes.
- Initiated and led the migration from on-premise to AWS, introduced DevOps culture, and established release cadence with quality gates across services and product engineering.
- Shaped the digital product portfolio including CRM and Core Banking; partnered directly with executives and go-to-market on sequencing and trade-offs.

INFRASTRUCTURE

Kubernetes Docker
Terraform AWS
Distributed systems
Event-driven architecture
Data pipelines
Observability

LANGUAGES & STACK

Go Rust Elixir
Scala TypeScript
PostgreSQL
GitHub Actions

LEADERSHIP

Startup scaling
Early-stage execution
Manager of managers
Manager of individual contributors
Hiring & levelling
Coaching & 1:1s
Founder

DELIVERY

Lightweight process
Squad model
Pod model
Shipping culture
Reliability
PM partnership

LANGUAGES

French Native
English C1
German A2

EDUCATION

MSc Informatics & Networking
EIGSI La Rochelle, 2009

OTHER EXPERIENCES

Wonderful	<i>Field CTO — AI platform, enterprise delivery</i>	Jan 2026 — Mar 2026
Scrypt	<i>Head of Engineering — reorganised into squads, introduced lightweight tooling</i>	Nov 2025 — Dec 2025
Pictet Asset Management	<i>Site Reliability Engineer — K8s, Terraform, Go</i>	2021
Union Bancaire Privée	<i>Internal Auditor — IT Security</i>	Nov 2018 — Jul 2020
Banque de Commerce et de Placements	<i>Technical Leader — Go, Kubernetes</i>	Nov 2017 — Oct 2018
SIX Swiss Exchange	<i>Scala Developer — REST services</i>	Feb 2017 — Oct 2017
Glencore	<i>Software Engineer — commodity trade systems</i>	Aug 2016 — Jan 2017
Swissquote	<i>Technical Lead — consumer fintech (millions of users)</i>	Jan 2016 — Jul 2016
Rolux SA	<i>Software Engineer (5 years, hands-on)</i>	Jan 2011 — Dec 2015
Axway	<i>Software Engineer — SEPA banking, CI/CD adoption</i>	Jan 2009 — Dec 2010

LOCATION

Geneva, Switzerland
Swiss resident
CET time zone